

Ryan Truong

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Education

Harvard University PhD Psychology	9/2025 - Present
University of Texas at Austin B.S. Psychology	8/2021 - 12/2023
University of Texas at Arlington UT Coordinated Admission Program	8/2020 - 5/2021

Research Experience

CCN Lab, Harvard University <i>RA / Graduate RA</i> PI: Sam Gershman Supervisor(s): Lance Ying • Developed online interfaces for computational cognitive science experiments • Working on computational models of cognition	7/2024 - 2025 9/2025 - Present
Goris Lab, UT Austin <i>Research / Laboratory Technician</i> PI: Robbe Goris Supervisor(s): Gabriela Coello-Reyes, Akash Raj • Managed non-human primate (NHP) care and surgical procedures, including enrichment, chairing, and margin cleanings • Examined visual restoration by modeling and analyzing lesioned artificial neural networks	1/2023 - 6/2024 9/2024 - 5/2025
CasCogLab, UT Austin <i>Part-time RA</i> PI: Desmond Ong Supervisor(s): Emma Gueorguieva, Yoon Kyung Lee • Assisted with experimental studies and transcriptions • Made Empathy-Intervention web platform	9/2023 - 6/2024 9/2024 - 5/2025
Gabrieli Lab, MIT McGovern Institute <i>Summer Research Intern</i> PI: John Gabrieli Supervisor(s): Clark Roberts • Created custom fMRI tasks for clinical trials and DDM models for binary choice tasks • Modeled latent class trajectories and cross-lagged network models for mental health outcomes in open-source datasets (ABCD dataset)	6/2024 - 11/2024

Publications

* denotes equal contribution

Ying, L.*, **Truong, R.***, Tenenbaum, J. B., & Gershman, S. J. (2026). Using Theory of Mind to Arbitrate between Social and Non-social Learning. (*arXiv:2607.28601*)

- Ying, L., **Truong, R.**, Sharma, P., Zhao, K. I., Cloos, N., Allen, K. R., Griffiths, T. L., Collins, K. M., Hernández-Orallo, J., Isola, P., Gershman, S. J., & Tenenbaum, J. B. (2026). AI Gamestore: Scalable, Open-Ended Evaluation of Machine General Intelligence with Human Games. (*Submitted*)
- Ying, L., **Truong, R.**, Collins, K. M., Zhang, C. E., Wei, M., Brooke-Wilson, T., Zhi-Xuan, T., Wong, L., & Tenenbaum, J. B. (2025). Language-Informed Synthesis of Rational Agent Models for Grounded Theory-of-Mind Reasoning On-The-Fly. (*Findings of EMNLP, 2025*)
- Ying, L.*, Hillel, A.*, **Truong, R.***, Mansinghka, V., Tenenbaum, J. B., & Zhi-Xuan, T. (2025). Belief Attribution as Mental Explanation: The Role of Accuracy, Informativity, and Causality. (*CogSci 2025*)
- Ying, L., **Truong, R.**, Tenenbaum, J. B., & Gershman, S. J. (2025). Adaptive social learning using theory of mind. (*CogSci 2025*)

Mentorship & Service

Becoming a Brain Scientist (MBB S-102)

2026

Harvard Summer School

Graduate Research Mentor

- Mentored two students through summer research projects, meeting weekly and advising on the write-up of a final research paper

Health Professions Recruitment and Exposure Program (HPREP)

2025 - 2026

Harvard Medical School

Graduate Student Mentor

- Provided weekly one-on-one mentorship and guidance to high school students interested in pursuing careers in the health sciences and medicine

Graduate Student Mentorship Initiative (GSMI)

2025

Cientifico Latino

Graduate Student Mentor

- Guided prospective STEM graduate students through the application process by providing written feedback and weekly one-on-one meetings

Prospective Ph.D. & RA Event in Psychology (PPREP)

2025

Harvard Psychology Program

Graduate Student Advisor

- Advised prospective applicants navigating the Psychology PhD admissions and application process